

Zijian Liu

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📄 Zijian Liu

Education

- Sept. 2022 **Department of Technology, Operations, and Statistics at Stern School of Business, New York University, NY**
– Aug. 2026 (Expected) Ph.D. Candidate in Operations Management, advisor: Zhengyuan Zhou
- Sept. 2019 **Courant Institute of Mathematical Sciences, New York University, NY**
– May 2021 M.S. in Computer Science
- Sept. 2015 **School of Computer Science, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China**
– June 2019 B.Eng. in Software Engineering

Research Interests

Mathematical Optimization, Theoretical Machine Learning

Publications & Manuscripts

(* indicates equal contribution, † indicates alphabetical order)

- ICLR 2026 **Clipped Gradient Methods for Nonsmooth Convex Optimization under Heavy-Tailed Noise: A Refined Analysis** [Link]
Zijian Liu
- ALT 2026 **Online Convex Optimization with Heavy Tails: Old Algorithms, New Regrets, and Applications** [Link]
Zijian Liu
- ICML 2025 **Improved Last-Iterate Convergence of Shuffling Gradient Methods for Nonsmooth Convex Optimization** [Link]
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
- ICLR 2025 **Nonconvex Stochastic Optimization under Heavy-Tailed Noises: Optimal Convergence without Gradient Clipping** [Link]
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
- ICML 2024 **On the Last-Iterate Convergence of Shuffling Gradient Methods** [Link]
(Oral) Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
- ICML 2024 **On the Convergence of Projected Bures-Wasserstein Gradient Descent under Euclidean Strong Convexity** [Link]
Junyi Fan*, Yuxuan Han*, Zijian Liu, Jian-Feng Cai, Yang Wang, Zhengyuan Zhou
- ICLR 2024 **Revisiting the Last-Iterate Convergence of Stochastic Gradient Methods** [Link]
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
- COLT 2023 **Breaking the Lower Bound with (Little) Structure: Acceleration in Non-Convex Stochastic Optimization with Heavy-Tailed Noise** [Link]
Zijian Liu, Jiawei Zhang, Zhengyuan Zhou
- ICML 2023 **High Probability Convergence of Stochastic Gradient Methods** [Link]
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Thien Hang Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen

- ICLR 2023 **On the Convergence of AdaGrad(Norm) on $\mathbb{R}^d$: Beyond Convexity, Non-Asymptotic Rate and Acceleration** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
- ICML 2022 **Adaptive Accelerated (Extra-)Gradient Methods with Variance Reduction** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen
- ICML 2022 **Distributionally Robust Q -Learning** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu, Qinxun Bai, Jose Blanchet, Perry Dong, Wei Xu, Zhengqing Zhou, Zhengyuan Zhou
- Operations Research
Major Revision **Product Return as a Sequence of Search Processes: Optimality and Search Duration** [\[Available upon Request\]](#)
Xiaoyu Fan[†], Srikanth Jagabathula[†], Zijian Liu[†], Eitan Muller[†]
- Manuscript **Near-Optimal Non-Convex Stochastic Optimization under Generalized Smoothness** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu, Srikanth Jagabathula, Zhengyuan Zhou
- Manuscript **Stochastic Nonsmooth Convex Optimization with Heavy-Tailed Noises: High-Probability Bound, In-Expectation Rate and Initial Distance Adaptation** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu, Zhengyuan Zhou
- Manuscript **META-STORM: Generalized Fully-Adaptive Variance Reduced SGD for Unbounded Functions** [\[Link\]](#)
Zijian Liu*, Ta Duy Nguyen*, Thien Hang Nguyen*, Alina Ene, Huy L. Nguyen

Talks

- Jul. 2024 *The 25th International Symposium on Mathematical Programming*
- Jul. 2024 *The 41st International Conference on Machine Learning*
- Feb. 2026 *The 37th International Conference on Algorithmic Learning Theory*
- Mar. 2026 *The 2026 INFORMS Optimization Society Conference*

Services

- Journal *IEEE Journal on Selected Areas in Information Theory (JSAIT)*
- Reviewer *IEEE Transactions on Automatic Control (TAC)*
IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology (TCST)
Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)
Management Science
Mathematical Finance
SIAM Journal on Optimization (SIOPT)
Statistica Sinica
- Conference *ICML 2022, 2024, 2025, 2026*
- Reviewer *NeurIPS 2024, 2025*
ICLR 2025, 2026
ALT 2025, 2026
- Organizer *MOILS seminar (internal seminar series at NYU Stern) Spring 2023*

Teaching Experience

(**U** denotes undergraduate-level courses, **G** denotes graduate-level courses)

- Summer 2025 **Operations Management (U)**, Instructor New York University
Class Size: 15
- Design and teach two 3-hour lectures per week independently
 - Grade assignments and exams and hold office hours

Fall 2024	Operations Management (U) , Teaching Fellow Instructor: Prof. Divya Singhvi ○ Grade assignments and exams and hold office hours	New York University
Summer 2024	Stochastic Modeling & Simulation (U) , Teaching Fellow Instructor: Prof. Joshua Reed ○ Grade assignments and exams and hold office hours	New York University
Fall 2020	Bayesian Machine Learning (G) , Section Leader Instructor: Prof. Andrew Gordon Wilson ○ Teach supplementary materials and advanced topics in recitation sessions ○ Grade assignments and exams and hold office hours	New York University